



Breathe in some fresh 'Air' with KDE 4.3 beta 1

Seems like the wait for the new version of KDE4 is almost over within the KDE Community after the first preview of the third iteration of the KDE4 desktop, applications and development platform—KDE 4.3 Beta 1. The KDE team is now in bug-fixing mode in order to provide a smooth KDE 4.3.0 to end users in late July.

Highlights of KDE 4.3 are:

Integration of many new technologies, such as PolicyKit and Geolocation services.

New window animation effects, a more usable run command pop-up and many new and improved additions in Plasma.

Many bug-fixes and improvements across all applications and more integration of features introduced since the release of KDE4.

KDE 4.3 will also introduce a brand new desktop theme dubbed Air, replacing Oxygen. According to KDE Pinheiro [pinheiro-kde.blogspot.com/2009/02/air-and-kde-43.html], "Air is supposed to be different

from what Oxygen is, something that tries to appeal to a user base looking for a more 'sexy' experience than Oxygen (yeah I know you are out there :)), but to still have the capability of merging nicely with what we have now... KDE will very shortly become the desktop you need and not the desktop we think you need."

Note that KDE 4.3 Beta 1 is not suitable for end users. Its sole purpose is gathering feedback and testing. Visit the KDE 4.3 beta 1 Info Page at kde.org/info/4.2.85.php to get started.

Moblin 2.0 beta for netbooks and nettops

The Moblin steering committee has released Moblin v2.0 beta for netbooks and nettops for developer testing. With this release, developers can begin to experience and work with the source code of the visually rich, interactive user interface designed for Intel Atom-based netbooks. Moblin is built using GNOME Mobile Technologies, and supports existing Linux desktop applications.

Moblin v2.0 features include a new, visually rich user experience, optimised for netbook and nettops, building on the latest FOSS graphics technologies, such as Clutter, DRI2, and KMS. The *m_zone*, acting as the 'home screen' panel, provides instant access to your synchronised calendar, tasks, appointments, recently used files, and real-time updates from your friends on social networking sites. Besides this, aggregation of your social networking content provides you with the ability to see your social networking activities on one screen. There's also a Web browser optimised for the Moblin 2.0 netbook user interface; a 'zoomable' media player; a user interface for connection management; an updated connection manager (ConnMan); and, of course, support for Linux desktop applications.

According to the announcement, the Moblin images [moblin.org/downloads] are being tested with the following platforms: Acer Aspire*One, Asus eeePC* 901, 1000H, Dell Mini 9, MSI Wind, Lenovo S10, Samsung NC10, HP Mini 1010 and 1120NR (wired networking only for now).



RHEL 4.8 released

Red Hat has released the eighth update to RHEL 4. The new version sports improved virtualisation performance and scale, with optimised device drivers for RHEL 4 virtual guests deployed on the KVM hypervisor that's supposed to be included in future RHEL 5 releases, apart from virtual guest support for up to 256 disk devices (increased from 16). It also has improved Windows interoperability and filesystem support due to numerous Samba enhancements; performance improvements due to three new 'kernel tunables' that allow users to optimise application performance by reducing latency and improving utilization; and enhanced developer support with an updated GNU Compiler Collection that allows users to compile applications on RHEL 4 with compatibility with RHEL 5. This helps them prepare for moving applications to the newer Red Hat releases. More details can be found at www.redhat.com.

New CUDA Toolkit 2.2

NVIDIA has released version 2.2 of the CUDA Toolkit and SDK for GPU computing featuring a visual profiler, improved OpenGL interoperability, zero-copy, a hardware debugger for the GPU, etc. The CUDA Visual Profiler is a graphical tool that enables the profiling of C applications running on the GPU. This latest release of the CUDA Visual Profiler includes metrics for memory transactions, giving developers visibility into one of the most important areas they can tune into for better performance. The release also delivers up to 2x bandwidth savings for video processing applications.

